4 Implementing consumer-driven contract testing for web applications

This chapter covers

- Guidelines in writing consumer contract tests
- Contract testing tooling setup for the consumer
- Writing consumer contract tests between a web application and data provider
- Publishing contracts to a Pact Broker

At this point, we hope you're itching to start writing your first contract test! As mentioned in chapter 2, it's always better to start with the "Why" and to understand what pain points contract testing is trying to solve before you rush in to try it out just because someone told you to. Building on the Why, it's essential to have a solid understanding of the core concepts and principles of contract testing. If you feel that you want to read the previous chapters again to solidify your knowledge further, please go ahead. We'd rather you make sure you fully understand how contract testing works before trying out the implementation part.

If you have a solid grasp of the Why and the foundational concepts, it's time to get hands-on with contract testing. This technical chapter will guide you through the setup process step-by-step, ensuring that you can start implementing contract tests effectively. We'll first provide recommended practices to help you write consumer contract tests. Next, you'll learn how to set up the necessary tools and libraries for contract testing in your specific development environment using the Pact tool. As mentioned in chapter 3, we use Pact because it's the standard tool for writing contract tests. Pact (https://docs.pact.io/) is a code-first tool for testing HTTP and message integrations using contract tests.